Image Storage & Social Media Sharing Policy

Purpose

Hockey Fever is committed to protecting the privacy and rights of all participants, staff and visitors. This policy explains how photographs and videos are collected, stored and shared in accordance with UK data protection legislation, including the UK General Data Protection Regulation (UK GDPR) and the Data Protection Act 2018.

Scope

This policy applies to:

- Photographs and videos captured during Hockey Fever activities, including sessions, camps, tournaments, festivals, school activities and events.
- Images shared on official Hockey Fever platforms, including our website, social media channels, promotional materials and event communications.
- Staff, volunteers, photographers, contractors and anyone handling images on Hockey Fever's behalf.

Throughout this policy, "images" includes photographs and videos.

Collection of Images

- Images will only be taken on Hockey Fever's behalf by authorised staff or approved photographers.
- Informed consent will be obtained before images are captured or used. For under-18s, Hockey Fever requires permission from a parent/carer and will also respect the wishes of the young person.
- Individuals will be informed about the intended uses of their images.
- Individuals may decline photography or withdraw permission without affecting their participation.

- Entry or attendance does not, by itself, constitute consent to photography or publication.

Photography and Social Media at GHA Tournaments and Festivals

Hockey Fever may take photographs and videos during Gloucestershire Hockey Association (GHA) tournaments and festivals to celebrate participation and promote junior hockey through Hockey Fever's website, social media and other event communications.

Clubs and schools are responsible for informing parents/carers and players about these arrangements, ensuring that recorded photography permissions cover images being taken and used by Hockey Fever for these purposes, and communicating any restrictions to Hockey Fever before each tournament.

At the pre-tournament team managers' meeting, organisers will ask whether any players have photography restrictions. Where restrictions apply, Hockey Fever will not photograph the team concerned, including during match play. If permissions have not been confirmed, the team will not be photographed until clarification has been obtained.

Hockey Fever will communicate restrictions to its authorised photographers and those responsible for selecting and publishing images. Clubs and schools must notify organisers promptly if permissions change.

Parents/carers and players may decline photography without affecting participation. Any concerns, changes to permissions or requests regarding photographs should be directed to Hockey Fever using the contact details below.

All images will be handled in accordance with this policy.

Storage and Retention of Images

- Images will be stored securely on password-protected business devices and secure, encrypted storage services managed or approved by Hockey Fever.
- Access will be restricted to authorised individuals who need the images for their work.
- Selected images may be retained in Hockey Fever's designated storage for up to three years. Images will be reviewed and deleted sooner where they are no longer needed or permission has been withdrawn.

- Images will only be retained beyond three years where a specific continuing purpose and appropriate permission have been documented.
- Unselected images and additional working copies will be deleted within 30 days once transfer to designated storage has been confirmed and the relevant publication work is complete.
- Deletion will include copies on staff devices, messaging applications, working folders and recently deleted folders, together with relevant backup copies where possible. Any backup copies that cannot be individually deleted will remain protected and expire through the normal backup cycle.

Sharing of Images

- Images may be shared on Hockey Fever's official website, social media accounts, promotional materials and event communications, within the purposes covered by the permission obtained.
- Only images that positively and appropriately reflect Hockey Fever's activities and values will be published.
- Children's full names, addresses, contact information or other identifying personal details will not be published alongside their images.
- Adults' full names will only be published with their explicit permission.
- Images will never be sold or passed to third parties for commercial gain.
- Approved photographers and social media contractors may handle images only as authorised by Hockey Fever and in accordance with this policy.
- On request, Hockey Fever will remove images from platforms it controls and stop using them in future publications. Copies already printed, downloaded or reshared by others may not be recoverable.

Photography and Image Handling Instructions

- Images must only be taken, transferred, stored and published by authorised individuals for approved Hockey Fever purposes.
- Photographers must be informed of photography restrictions before taking images. Restrictions must also be checked when selecting images for publication.
- Images must be transferred securely to Hockey Fever's designated storage location using an approved transfer method.
- Once receipt is confirmed and the relevant work is complete, additional copies must be deleted in accordance with the retention requirements above.

- Only images cleared for publication may be shared with the person responsible for social media.
- Images must not be passed to unauthorised individuals or used for personal purposes.
- Identifiable images of children must not be uploaded into generative AI tools.
- Photography concerns, accidental disclosures, lost devices or requests for removal must be reported promptly to Hockey Fever.
- Everyone handling images on Hockey Fever's behalf must follow this policy.

Safeguarding Considerations

- Extra care will be taken when capturing and sharing images of children and adults at risk.
- Group images will be prioritised over individual close-ups where appropriate. Photography restrictions apply equally to group and individual images.
- Images must show participants appropriately dressed and taking part in suitable activities.
- Images must not be taken in toilets, changing rooms or other private areas.
- Images that could cause embarrassment, distress or a safeguarding risk must not be published.
- A child's wish not to be photographed will be respected, even where a parent/carer has previously given permission.
- Safeguarding concerns relating to photography or image use must be reported promptly to Hockey Fever's Welfare Officer.

Artificial Intelligence

- Hockey Fever may use AI tools to assist with captions, written content, graphics, layouts and administrative activities.
- Identifiable photographs or videos of children must not be uploaded into generative AI tools, including when preparing social media posts or promotional materials.
- AI must not be used to fabricate, sexualise, misrepresent or materially alter the appearance of children.
- These requirements apply to staff, volunteers, contractors and anyone creating content on Hockey Fever's behalf.

Rights of Individuals

Individuals, or parents/carers acting appropriately on a child's behalf, may:

- Request access to personal images held by Hockey Fever.
- Withdraw consent to future photography and use of their images.
- Request removal of images from Hockey Fever's website and social media.
- Request deletion of stored images, subject to any applicable safeguarding or legal obligations.

Withdrawal of consent will not affect the lawfulness of use before consent was withdrawn.

Requests will be handled promptly and normally within one month. Where an image must be retained for a safeguarding or legal reason, Hockey Fever will explain this where appropriate and restrict its use.

Responsibilities and Review

- Hockey Fever will designate a responsible person to oversee image handling and respond to data protection queries.
- Staff, volunteers and contractors handling images will receive appropriate guidance on this policy.
- Records of photography permissions, restrictions and withdrawal requests will be maintained so that images can be checked before publication.
- Storage, access and deletion arrangements will be reviewed regularly.
- This policy will be reviewed annually, or sooner if practices, safeguarding requirements or relevant legislation change.

Contact

For photography concerns, removal requests or data protection queries, please contact Hockey Fever's person responsible for data protection:

Email: admin@hockeyfever.co.uk
Phone: 07775 270173